The comparison is only a rough overview. We recommend that you choose two or three services that best fit your use case and then jump into the details by reading the chapters to make your decision.

Table 1. Overview of data storage services

Service	Access	Maximum storage volume	Latency	Storage cost
S3	AWS API (SDKs, CLI), third-party tools	Unlimited	High	Very low
EBS (SSD)	Attached to an EC2 instance via network	16 TiB	Low	Low
EC2 Instance Store (SSD)	Attached to an EC2 instance directly	305 TB	Very low	Very low
EFS	NFSv4.1, for example, from an EC2 instance or on-premises	Unlimited	Medium	Medium
RDS (MySQL, SSD)	SQL	64 TiB	Medium	Low
ElastiCache	Redis/Memcached protocol	635 GiB	Low	High
DynamoDB	AWS API (SDKs, CLI)	Unlimited	Medium	Medium

Chapter 7 will introduce S3, a service offering object storage. You will learn how to integrate the object storage into your applications to implement a stateless server.